sequence of steps the individual woodworkers are taking, and the analysis of duplication of abstract steps involved.

Figure 7.4 depicts this flow for the construction of three chairs. The first chair is produced in four steps. Step 3 is building a custom tool and then using it; this workflow requires a long time but results in a high-quality chair. The second chair is built without a custom tool, resulting in a shorter build time but a lower-quality chair. Finally, the third workflow uses the platform, which produces a high-quality chair in a shorter time frame than even chair 2.

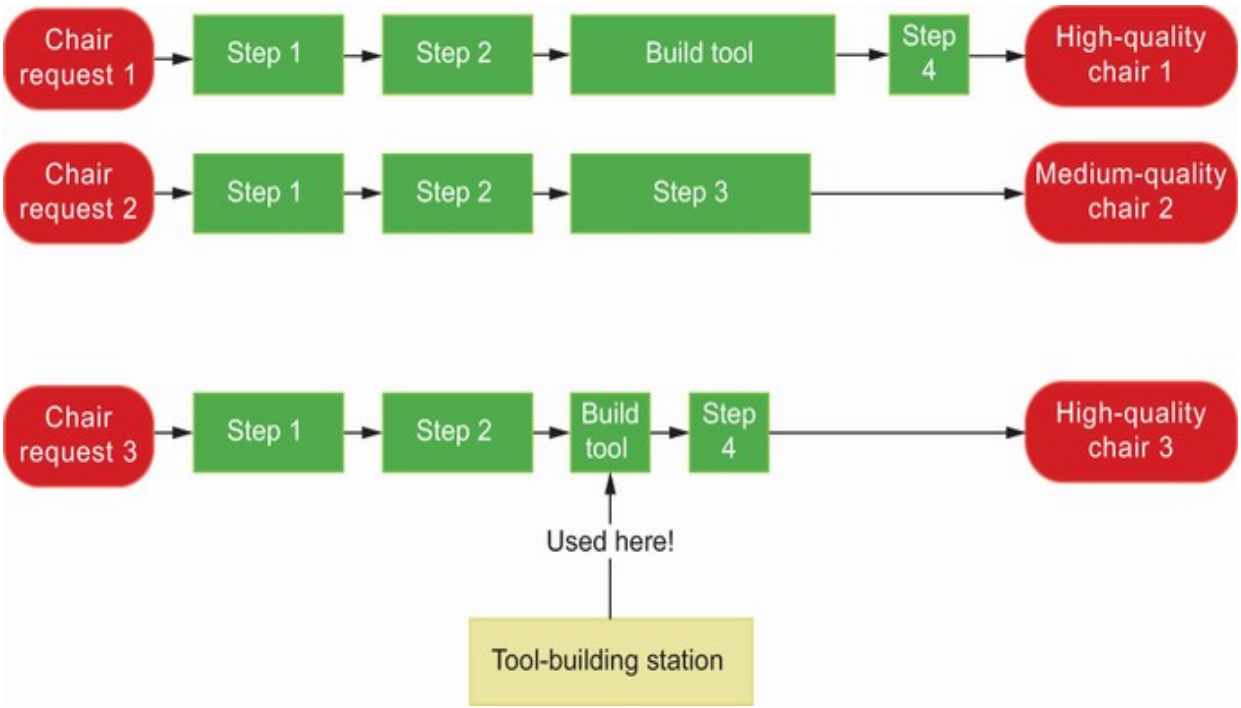


Figure 7.4 The workshop workflow speeds up, thanks to the platform.

Platform thinking is not an *alternative* to product thinking. We consider it simply a second lens through which to view things. The output-oriented lens still keeps an eye on the organizational perspective.

We recommend focusing on delivering foundational services that do the following: